

JONATHAN JACKSON

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SUMMARY

Personal Summary

Versatile cybersecurity professional with expertise in security engineering, incident response, and security automation. Skilled in network hardening, penetration testing, and cloud security (AWS, Azure), with a focus on aligning cybersecurity strategies to business goals. Strong foundation in Agile and DevOps practices, with a track record of enhancing security postures through innovative tool development and risk mitigation.

Experienced in managing complex systems, fostering cross-functional collaboration, and driving team performance within high-tempo environments. Passionate about mentorship and continuous improvement, with a commitment to developing resilient teams and advancing organizational security maturity.

As a **technology leader**, I excel at managing **complex systems** and enhancing security within agile environments. A **creative problem solver** with a keen eye for **collaboration and detail**, I thrive in dynamic settings, fostering innovation and adaptability. Passionate about **mentorship and team building**, and I leverage my expertise to cultivate resilient teams, drive **continuous improvement**, and fortify organizational security postures.

EXPERIENCE

VISTRA CORP.

Data Solutions Engineer

2022 – 2025

As a **Data Solutions Engineer**, I design, implement, and optimize **OSIsoft PI System solutions** to enhance **data operations, security, and performance**. My expertise includes **installing and configuring OSIsoft PI System components**, such as **Asset Framework (AF), OPC, PI System Explorer, PI Vision, PI Datalink, PI Builder, and PI SDK**. I have led **corporate patching replacements**, automating processes to improve **efficiency and security** while ensuring seamless **system integration**. By fostering strong relationships across teams, I align **PI solutions with organizational goals and long-term strategies**.

Remediated over 2,000 vulnerabilities, significantly improving security and system hardening.

- **Managed and optimized over 150 PI servers** across **50 plant sites in the U.S.**, ensuring high availability and performance.
- **Developed an automated system that saved 30 hours per week**, reducing manual workload and improving operational efficiency.

VISTRA CORP.

Senior Cyber Security Analyst

2019 – 2022

Served as the **Subject Matter Expert (SME)** for enterprise cybersecurity, specializing in endpoint protection, threat detection, and security automation. Led the integration and management of multiple security solutions to safeguard over **10,000 endpoints, workstations, and servers**. Designed and deployed automated security tools within corporate domains to enhance proactive threat detection, compliance, and incident response.

- **Subject Matter Expert (SME) for CrowdStrike Falcon, Carbon Black, SentinelOne, Windows Defender, and Zscaler**, ensuring **optimal endpoint protection across 10,000+ endpoints**.
- Led proactive threat hunting using Splunk, Anomali, and AnyRun, identifying hundreds of potential security threats, with 10 full-scale security incidents escalated for remediation.
- Conducted security assessments across corporate domains, identifying 30,000+ vulnerabilities using Nessus Professional, Nmap, AnyRun, and Anomali.
- Assisted application owners with vulnerability prioritization and patching efforts, ensuring high-risk issues were addressed in accordance with compliance frameworks.
- **Configured and optimized Zscaler tunnels** to enable secure access to corporate applications, initially deployed for **remote workers** but later standardized for **all employees**.

- **Implemented Zscaler to enforce secure web access policies, block malicious traffic, and prevent unauthorized data transfers, reducing exposure to web-based threats by 70%.**
- **Managed cybersecurity incidents** logged directly within AV security applications and escalated through the **Managed IT services provider**, responding to **over 7,300 incidents**, reducing Mean Time to Detect (MTTD) by **40%** and Mean Time to Respond (MTTR) by **35%**.
- Conducted forensic analysis using **Splunk, CrowdStrike, Carbon Black, SentinelOne, Windows Defender, Zscaler, and Abnormal Security**, successfully mitigating **multiple advanced persistent threats (APTs) and phishing campaigns**.
- Established strong relationships with security application vendors to ensure deployment of the **latest and most optimized versions** of their products, improving overall security effectiveness and reducing false positives.
- Strengthened adherence to **NIST, ISO 27001, and SOC 2** frameworks, improving audit pass rates from **80% to 95%** over two years.

HSOC CYBER

AI Cyber & Automation | Penetration Testing | Cybersecurity Research (Mentor/Intern)

2020 – Present

Built AI-assisted cybersecurity training, lab, and SOC workflows using Codex, ChatGPT, GitHub, structured prompts, and hands-on security labs to support analyst readiness, penetration testing practice, and operational cyber training.

- Built home/SOC security labs using VMware, VirtualBox, Linux, Windows Server, pfSense, firewalls, and segmented networks to simulate corporate infrastructure and adversary activity.
- Developed AI-assisted workflows using Codex, ChatGPT, GitHub, and prompt frameworks to create labs, troubleshooting guides, rubrics, incident reports, and technical documentation.
- Designed Packet Tracer troubleshooting labs with controlled IP, VLAN, ACL, routing, gateway, and endpoint misconfigurations to support structured network analysis and remediation practice.
- Created Junior Network Analyst Bootcamp website/content structure for networking fundamentals, SOC readiness, certification prep, Packet Tracer exercises, and portfolio deliverables.
- Supported HSOC Cyber training operations by building team-led coaching workflows, Trello accountability boards, lab progression systems, and realistic SOC-style project requirements.
- Conducted penetration testing and adversary emulation in Windows/Linux labs using Metasploit, Nmap, Burp Suite, Nikto, Splunk, Wazuh, and MITRE ATT&CK-aligned techniques.
- Performed reconnaissance, vulnerability exploitation, privilege escalation, lateral movement, log analysis, and detection-rule tuning in controlled environments.
- Built SOC-style exercises using SIEM telemetry, Python scripting, Linux, Windows Server, and incident response workflows to reinforce detection, containment, and documentation.
- Mentored fellows, interns, and team members on threat hunting, TTP analysis, IR workflows, troubleshooting methodology, secure configuration, and operational cyber practices.

IBM

Data Center Technician II

2017 – 2019

Managed and maintained data center operations, ensuring maximum uptime, reliability, and performance. Specialized in server virtualization, infrastructure management, and implementation of fault-tolerant solutions. Built out a complete data center from initial design to operational readiness, including hardware installation, structured cabling, and environmental controls.

- Managed virtualization and maintenance for over 300 servers across multiple operating systems, averaging 2–3 servers per week, improving resource utilization by 30% and reducing deployment times by 20%.
- Diagnosed and resolved approximately 16,000 Windows and Linux server issues, averaging 25 tickets per day, significantly reducing downtime and improving operational continuity.
- Performed system maintenance implementing RAID, NAS, and SAN solutions, enhancing fault tolerance and reducing system downtime by 25%.
- Built-out and configured an data center, including mounting equipment, ran Ethernet and fiber cabling, maintained detailed cable management, server and switch deployment, OS installation, and client onboarding.
- Monitored and managed environmental systems (cooling, power, humidity control) to ensure optimal data center conditions.
- Conducted regular backups, audits, and disaster recovery protocols, documented inventory, hardware changes, and system updates.
- Trained 3 new technicians, achieving a 92% efficiency rating measured through performance evaluations.
- Managed inventory control and maintained organized storage for spare parts and critical equipment.

NORTHWESTERN MUTUAL
Financial Representative

2015 – 2016

Developed personalized financial plans tailored to clients' unique goals and aspirations, ensuring alignment with their financial objectives. Provided expert advice and education to executives, business owners, and professionals, fostering long-term relationships built on trust and understanding. Conducted comprehensive assessments of clients' financial situations, offering tailored solutions that included insurance strategies, investment options, and retirement planning. Maintained up-to-date knowledge of financial products and market trends to provide clients with informed guidance.

UNITED STATES ARMY
Human Resources Officer (Adjutant General Officer - 42B)

2008 – 2013

Led and managed comprehensive human resources functions directly supporting Soldiers' welfare, readiness, and overall well-being. Assisted commanders at all levels by accounting for personnel and maintaining combat readiness for over 1,200 Soldiers. Served as Battalion S1 at two separate battalions, as well as Assistant and Interim Brigade S1. Successfully deployed and redeployed three units to and from Afghanistan, ensuring seamless personnel accountability. Processed and coordinated personnel actions including mail operations, leave, R&R, awards, promotions, demotions, disciplinary actions, retirements, and Military Balls.

UNITED STATES ARMY
Combat Medic Specialist (68W)

1997—2008

Provided emergency medical treatment and limited primary care to Soldiers in various operational and clinical settings. Administered emergency and routine medical treatment to battle and non-battle casualties during a 13-month deployment to Operation Iraqi Freedom, earning the Expert Field Medical Badge (EFMB) and Combat Medical Badge (CMB). Assisted with outpatient care under the supervision of physicians, nurses, or physician assistants. Airborne qualified and actively trained Iraqi Army personnel as Combat Lifesavers, enhancing allied medical readiness. Served as lead medic during a critical mass casualty event, saving the lives of four cadets.

EDUCATION

CAMERON UNIVERSITY
Bachelor of Science (May 2008)

CERTIFICATIONS

- HSOC-Verified Cybersecurity Work Experience (2025)
- Tanium Advanced Content Development, Tanium (2024)
- OSISOFT PI System Administration Course, OSISOFT (2023)
- Splunk Fundamentals I, II & III, Splunk (2020)
- CEH, EC-Council (2018)
- Server+, CompTIA (2017)
- IT Security Specialist Certificate, My Computer Career (2017)
- IT System Administrator Certificate, My Computer Career (2017)
- CompTIA Security+, CompTIA (2017)
- CompTIA A+, CompTIA (2017)
- Server+, CompTIA (2017)
- AWS Cloud Practitioner, AWS (In-progress)